

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

**Streamlining IT Procurement:
Automating Standard Laptop Orders with
Flow**

Project Planning, User Stories, Workflow Design, Testing & Delivery

Document Item	Details
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow
Process Area	IT Procurement / Hardware Provisioning
Automation Platform	Microsoft Power Automate (Flow)
Document Type	Project Planning & Technical Documentation
Version	1.0
Prepared For	Academic / Project Submission

1. Project Overview

The project aims to streamline the procurement of standard laptops by automating the request, approval, procurement, notification, and tracking process using Microsoft Power Automate (Flow). Instead of relying on emails, spreadsheets, and manual follow-ups, employees submit a standardized laptop request form. The Flow validates the request, routes it to the appropriate approver, records the request, notifies the procurement team, and communicates the final status to the requester.

2. Problem Statement

Standard laptop procurement can become slow and error-prone when requests are handled manually. Common issues include incomplete information, repeated email communication, delayed approvals, difficulty tracking request status, inconsistent records, and lack of visibility for IT and procurement teams.

3. Project Objectives

- Create a standardized digital laptop request process.
- Automate approval routing for standard laptop orders.
- Reduce manual email-based communication and follow-ups.
- Maintain a centralized record of requests and their status.
- Automatically notify employees, approvers, and procurement staff.
- Improve traceability, processing time, and reporting.

4. Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope
Standard laptop requests	Non-standard/custom hardware procurement
Employee request submission	Vendor contract negotiation
Approval workflow	Physical delivery operations
Procurement notification	Repair and warranty management
Status tracking and notifications	Complex asset lifecycle management
Request reporting	International tax/customs automation

5. Agile Planning Logic

The project can be organized into Epics, User Stories, Sprints, and Story Points. An Epic represents a major project capability, while a User Story represents a smaller piece of functionality that can be completed within a sprint.

Story Point	Effort Level
1	Very easy task
2	Normal task
3	Moderate task
5	Difficult task

6. Product Backlog

Sprint	Epic	User Story	Task / Acceptance Focus	Points	Priority
Sprint 1	Request Intake	USN-1	Employee submits standard laptop request	2	High
Sprint 1	Request Intake	USN-2	Validate mandatory request information	2	High

Sprint 1	Approval	USN-3	Route request to manager/IT approver	3	High
Sprint 1	Approval	USN-4	Record approval or rejection decision	2	High
Sprint 2	Procurement	USN-5	Notify procurement team of approved order	3	High
Sprint 2	Procurement	USN-6	Create/update procurement tracking record	3	High
Sprint 2	Notification	USN-7	Notify requester of status changes	2	Medium
Sprint 2	Reporting	USN-8	Provide request status/reporting view	3	Medium

7. Sprint Plan & Story Point Calculation

Sprint	Stories	Story Points	Total
Sprint 1	USN-1, USN-2, USN-3, USN-4	2+2+3+2	9
Sprint 2	USN-5, USN-6, USN-7, USN-8	3+3+2+3	11
Total	8 stories	9+11	20

Average velocity after two completed sprints = Total completed story points / Number of sprints
= 20 / 2 = 10 story points per sprint.

This velocity is used as a planning reference and should be recalculated using actual completed work in future iterations.

8. Current Process vs Automated Process

Stage	Manual Process	Automated Flow
Request	Email / informal request	Standardized online form
Validation	Manual checking	Automatic mandatory-field validation
Approval	Email follow-up	Automated approval request
Tracking	Spreadsheet/email	Centralized list/database
Procurement	Manual notification	Automatic procurement notification

Status update	Manual email	Automatic status notifications
Reporting	Manual consolidation	Filterable tracking/reporting view

9. Proposed Flow Design

High-level automation sequence:

1. Employee submits the Standard Laptop Request form.
2. Flow trigger starts when a new request is submitted.
3. Flow retrieves the submitted request details.
4. Flow validates mandatory fields and request type.
5. Request is logged with a unique Request ID.
6. Approval request is sent to the configured approver.
7. If rejected, the requester is notified and the request is closed.
8. If approved, the procurement team receives an automated order notification.
9. Procurement updates the order status in the tracking system.
10. Requester receives status and completion notifications.

10. Flow Architecture

Component	Purpose
Microsoft Forms / Power Apps	Collect standardized laptop requests
Power Automate	Orchestrate validation, approvals, notifications, and updates
SharePoint List / Dataverse	Store request and status information
Approvals	Capture manager/IT approval decision
Outlook / Teams	Send notifications and approval messages
Power BI / SharePoint Views	Provide reporting and tracking

11. Request Data Fields

Field	Type	Required	Example
Request ID	Auto-generated	Yes	LAP-2026-001
Employee Name	Text	Yes	Employee Name

Employee ID	Text	Yes	EMP001
Department	Choice	Yes	Finance
Manager	Person	Yes	Manager Name
Laptop Model	Choice	Yes	Standard Business Laptop
Quantity	Number	Yes	1
Business Justification	Multiple lines	Yes	New employee onboarding
Required Date	Date	Yes	15-Oct-2026
Status	Choice	Yes	Pending Approval
Approval Decision	Choice	No	Approved / Rejected
Procurement Reference	Text	No	PO-0001

12. User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

USN-1 – Submit Request

As an employee, I want to submit a standard laptop request using a form so that IT receives all required information.

Acceptance Criteria: Request is submitted successfully; mandatory fields are enforced; a Request ID is generated.

USN-3 – Approve Request

As an approver, I want to receive an automated approval request so that I can approve or reject the order.

Acceptance Criteria: Approver receives request details; decision is recorded; workflow branches correctly.

USN-5 – Notify Procurement

As a procurement team member, I want approved orders to be sent automatically so that I can process them without manual follow-up.

Acceptance Criteria: Only approved requests are sent; procurement receives complete order information.

USN-7 – Notify Requester

As an employee, I want automatic status updates so that I know whether my request is pending, approved, rejected, or completed.

Acceptance Criteria: Notifications are triggered at defined status changes and contain the Request ID.

13. Decision Logic

Condition	Action
Required fields missing	Stop processing and notify requester to correct the request
Standard laptop request	Continue to approval
Approval = Rejected	Set status to Rejected and notify requester
Approval = Approved	Set status to Approved and notify procurement
Procurement completed	Set status to Completed and notify requester
Flow error	Log error and notify support/IT administrator

14. Status Model

- Submitted
- Validation
- Pending Approval
- Approved
- Rejected
- Sent to Procurement
- Ordered
- Completed
- Cancelled
- Error

15. Security & Governance

- Use organization-approved Microsoft accounts and connectors.
- Apply least-privilege access to request and procurement data.
- Restrict approval and procurement actions to authorized roles.
- Avoid storing unnecessary personal information.
- Maintain an audit trail of approvals, changes, and notifications.
- Use environment-specific connections and credentials.
- Apply retention and access policies according to organizational requirements.

16. Testing Plan

Test Case	Expected Result
Valid request submission	Request created with unique ID
Missing mandatory field	Validation prevents incorrect submission
Approval accepted	Request moves to Approved and procurement is notified
Approval rejected	Request moves to Rejected and requester is notified
Procurement status update	Requester receives updated status
Duplicate submission	Duplicate handling/validation follows configured rule
Flow connector failure	Error is logged and support notification is generated
Unauthorized access	User cannot access restricted procurement data

17. Project Tracker & Velocity

Sprint	Planned Story Points	Completed Story Points	Status
Sprint 1	9	To be measured	Planned
Sprint 2	11	To be measured	Planned

Velocity should be calculated from completed story points. For two completed sprints, Velocity = (Sprint 1 completed points + Sprint 2 completed points) / 2.

18. KPIs / Success Measures

- Average time from request submission to approval.
- Average time from approval to procurement order.
- Percentage of requests processed without manual intervention.
- Percentage of requests returned due to missing information.
- Approval turnaround time.
- Number of overdue or stuck requests.
- Flow failure rate.
- Requester satisfaction.

19. Benefits

- Faster and more consistent standard laptop ordering.
- Reduced administrative effort.
- Improved visibility of request status.
- Fewer incomplete or incorrectly routed requests.

- Better auditability of approvals and procurement actions.
- Centralized reporting for IT and procurement teams.

20. Future Enhancements

- Automated purchase-order creation through an approved procurement system.
- Vendor integration for order and delivery status.
- Automated asset registration after delivery.
- Integration with employee onboarding/offboarding processes.
- Dashboard with SLA, volume, aging, and turnaround metrics.
- Escalation notifications for overdue approvals.

21. Conclusion

Automating standard laptop procurement with Power Automate provides a structured and traceable workflow from request submission through approval and procurement completion. The proposed design standardizes data collection, automates routine decisions and notifications, and creates a single source of truth for request tracking. The approach can be implemented incrementally through Agile sprints and extended later with procurement, asset-management, and reporting integrations.

22. Suggested Flow Diagram

**Employee Request → Validate Request → Log Request → Approval → Rejected? →
Notify Employee → END**
Approved → Notify Procurement → Order/Update Status → Complete → Notify Employee

23. Document Approval

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Project Owner			
IT / Procurement Lead			
Approver			